Developer onboarding

Welcome. This is everything **you** (a developer joining a project) need to do to start working in mykan and driving it from Claude Code. It picks up **after the project owner has added you** — two things happen on their side first:

1. **Your email is whitelisted** so you can sign in at all.
2. **The project is shared with you** so it's visible once you're in.

You don't do either of those — if you can't sign in or can't see the project, that's on the owner, not you (see Troubleshooting). Everything below is yours to do.

Use the **exact Google account** whose email the owner whitelisted. A different Google account — even yours — will be rejected. (For Gmail addresses, dots and `+tags` don't matter: `jane.doe@gmail.com` and `janedoe+work@gmail.com` are the same account, just as Google treats them.)

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1. Sign in

1. Go to **https://kanban.dbwoodward.com**.
2. Click **Sign in with Google** and pick the whitelisted account.
3. You land on your **projects list**. The project the owner shared with you is there — click it to open its board. Once you're inside a project, the back-chevron in the top bar (**Switch project**) jumps between projects.

If you see **"That account is not authorized to use Mykan,"** you signed in with the wrong Google account. Sign out and retry with the whitelisted one.

2. (Recommended) Connect your GitHub

If your project uses the GitHub integration (issues/PRs mirrored as cards), connect **your own** GitHub PAT so refreshes and write-backs are attributed to *you*, not a shared identity:

- Click the **GitHub icon** in the top bar and follow the connect flow.
- Full detail — token scopes, org-repo scoping, what syncs — is in `github-integration.md`.

Skip this if your project doesn't touch GitHub.

3. Connect Claude Code over MCP

This is what lets Claude Code (interactive **and** headless/cron) list your projects, move cards, edit items, and drive the GitHub tools **as you**. You need Claude Code installed first.

a. Mint your personal token

1. In mykan's top bar, click the **key icon** (🔑, next to the GitHub icon) → the **MCP access tokens** panel opens.
2. Optionally type a **label** (e.g. `laptop`, `cron agent`) so you can tell tokens apart later.
3. Click **Generate token**.
4. A `mk_…` value appears with **"Copy this token now — it won't be shown again."** Copy it immediately — only its hash is stored, so it is **unrecoverable** afterward. If you lose it, just generate another and revoke the old one.

The token carries **your identity and your GitHub PAT reach** — treat it like a password. Revoke any token from the same panel (the ✕); revocation is immediate.

b. Register with Claude Code

The panel shows a ready-to-paste command right under the token. It registers the server at **user scope** — available in every project on your machine, no repo secret, no approval prompt:

```
claude mcp add --transport http --scope user mykan \
  https://kanban.dbwoodward.com/mcp \
  --header "Authorization: Bearer <your mk_… token>"
```

The **same** command and token work for headless/cron agents — there is no browser step. (Interactive browser OAuth — an "Authenticate → Google" button — is **not** built; the token is the intended mechanism and is actually simpler for headless use.)

c. Verify

```
claude mcp get mykan          # should show ✔ Connected
```

Then in a Claude Code session, `/mcp` (or `/tools`) should list the mykan tools: `mcp__mykan__list_projects`, `mcp__mykan__update_item_status`, and the rest. Your token lives only in `~/.claude.json` on your machine — never in the repo.

> If you registered before new tools shipped, restart the session — MCP tool lists load once per session.

4. Work

Ask Claude Code naturally — it maps to the tools:

- *"List my mykan projects / items in Permit Saige"* → `list_projects`, `list_items`
- *"Move KANBAN-N to In Progress / Done"* → `update_item_status`
- *"Create a task in Permit Saige: …"* → `create_item`
- *"Refresh KANBAN-N from GitHub"* → `refresh_item_from_github`

- *"Show me KANBAN-N"* → `get_item` (description, decisions, open questions, progress summary; attached files via `get_attachment`)
- *"Tag / assign / re-parent KANBAN-N"* → `set_item_tags`, `set_item_assignees`, `set_item_parent`, `set_item_area`

How a card is organised

Every card has more than a description, and Claude Code is told to keep each thing in its place:

- **Description** — a clean, living spec (objective, scope, plan, acceptance), edited in place with `set_item_body` when the plan changes. Old versions are kept in the item's history.
- **Progress notes** — one short checkpoint per meaningful step (`append_item_note`). Progress never goes in the description.
- **Questions** — anything the card leaves undecided (`ask_question`), closed with `answer_question` once the owner decides.
- **Decisions** — what the project owner decided (`record_decision`). Your agent records decisions; it doesn't make them.

Entries are editable and versioned (`update_item_entry`, `list_item_entry_versions`, `restore_item_entry_version`), and each is capped at 2,000 characters. Put longer detail in the repo or the PR and link it.

Full tool list and semantics: `mcp-setup.md`.

If the owner installed the **work-item** skill for you, you can also say *"work the next Permit Saige item"* and Claude Code will pick it up, move it to In Progress, do the build from its description, and move it to Done.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause	Fix
"That account is not authorized" on sign-in	Wrong Google account, or not whitelisted yet	Use the whitelisted account; if it still fails, the owner needs to whitelist your email (for Gmail, dots and `+tags` are ignored, so a different spelling of the same address is fine)
Signed in, but the project isn't listed	Project not shared with you	Ask the owner to share it (adds you to the project's members)
`claude mcp get mykan` shows not connected	Bad/typo'd token, or token revoked	Re-mint a token (§3a) and re-run the `claude mcp add` command
Tools missing in a session after connecting, or calls fail after a mykan deploy	Tool list and MCP session are cached for the Claude Code session	Restart the Claude Code session (or reconnect with `/mcp`)

Symptom	Cause	Fix
GitHub refresh/write-back fails	No GitHub PAT connected, or wrong scopes	Connect your PAT (§2); see `github-integration.md` for scopes

See also

- `mcp-setup.md` — the MCP server, tools, and how auth works
- `github-integration.md` — GitHub PAT setup and sync
- `DESIGN.md` — mykan's interaction patterns